

Loading a Live Kali Linux Disk on Your Windows System

What you will need:

- VMware
- A Windows 10 virtual machine
- Kali Live iso (Download from the Kali website)



We now have some experience of using Kali Linux for penetration testing and ethical hacking purposes. When using Kali, we have used this as a Virtual Machine that the operating has been installed on.

This is effective when conducting a penetration test in a networked environment, however, there are instances when this may not be necessary and it is more efficient to use the operating system in live.

By running /kali in live mode, you can:

- Run Kali Linux from a USB which allows the OS portability and therefor increases convenience. You can plug it into almost any computer, bypass the installed OS, and boot directly into Kali for quick testing or hacking.
- The live mode of Kali Linux doesn't install anything on your hard drive. It runs completely from RAM and the USB drive, which ensures that your host system remains unchanged and secure.
- Kali has tools for digital forensics and data recovery pre-installed. If your Windows system has issues, such as corrupt files, you can use Kali Live to recover files without altering the hard drive.

- On some systems, like those locked down by administrators, you might not have the ability to install software or access certain areas. Booting from Kali Live, gives you full control over the system, even allowing you to access files on the host hard drive.
- Kali Linux Live can also help you boot up the machine if your Windows system fails to boot , as well as access your files, and even attempt repairs.

It's important to remember that even though the above is possible with Kali Linux Live, the operating system, tools used and motivation around using it, should only be used in an ethical manner with full permission from the system owner being obtained.

Note: There is no need to be connected to a network or the internet for this exercise, therefor no configurations need to be made in the VMware network editor.

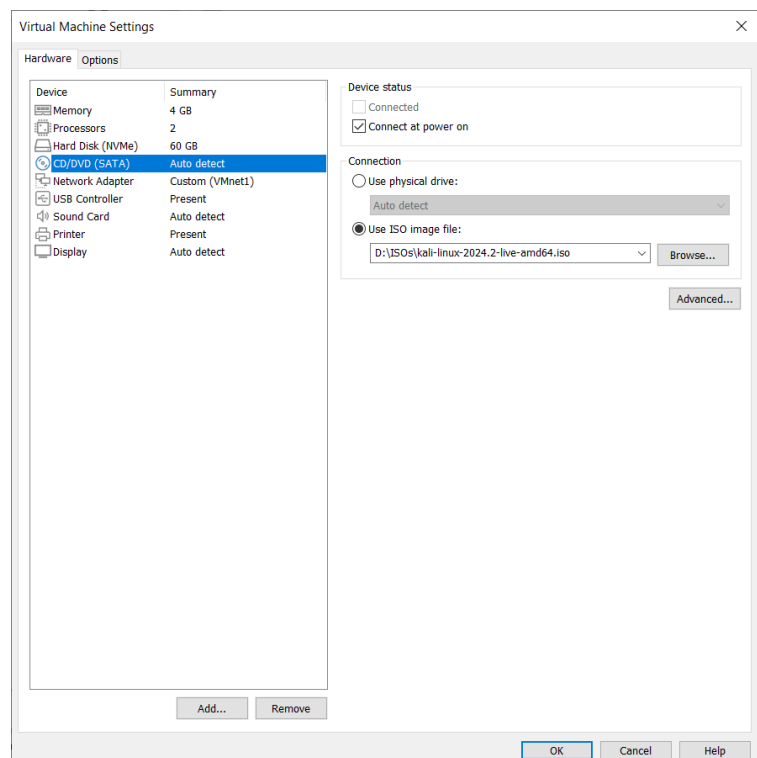
Before you can load the Kali Live OS, there are a couple of settings that need to be changed on your Windows 10 virtual machine.

1. First load your Windows 10 machine in VMware



2. Open the machine settings and select the **CD/DVD (SATA)** option in the left-hand pane.

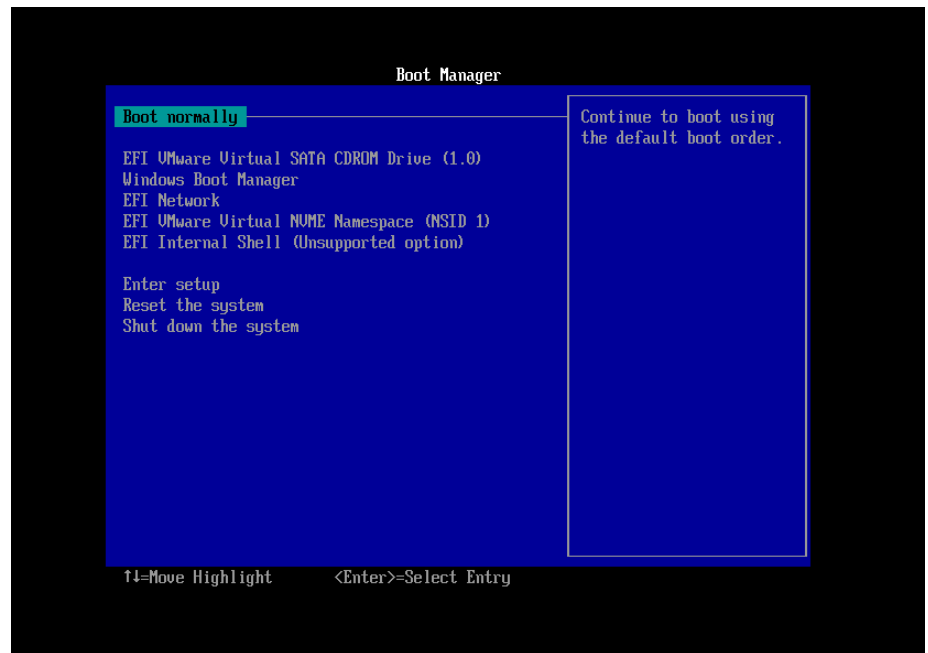
Select the **Use ISO image file** radial button, and browse to the location where you have stored the Kali Linux Live iso and select the file, then press OK.



3. Now turn on the VM and press the **F2** key, to enter the BIOS.

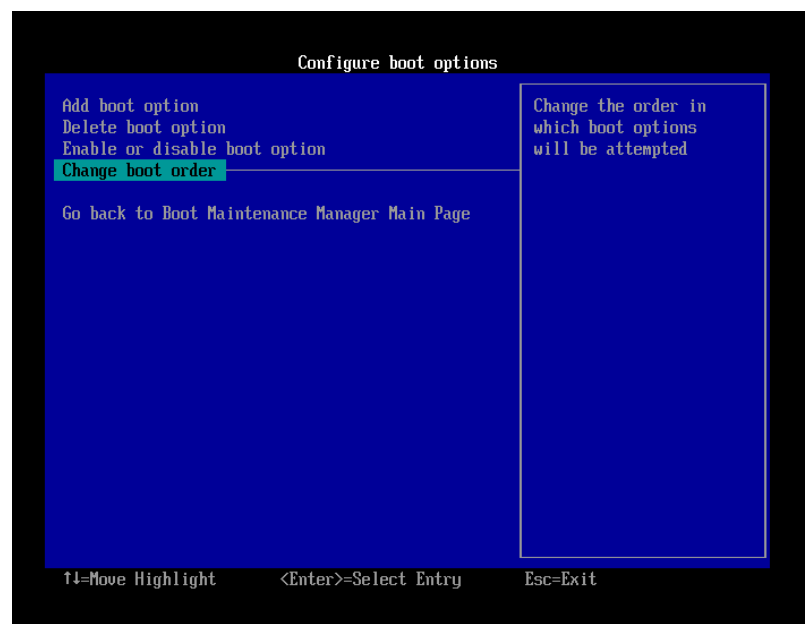
(Make sure that you click on the VM to ensure that your mouse and keyboard are inserted in the VM).

Your screen should then look like this.



4. From the boot manager menu, scroll down to highlight “**Enter Setup**” and press **Enter**.

This will open the “Configure boot options menu”. Select “**Change boot order**” and press enter.



5. Within the change boot order menu, you will see a list of boot options.

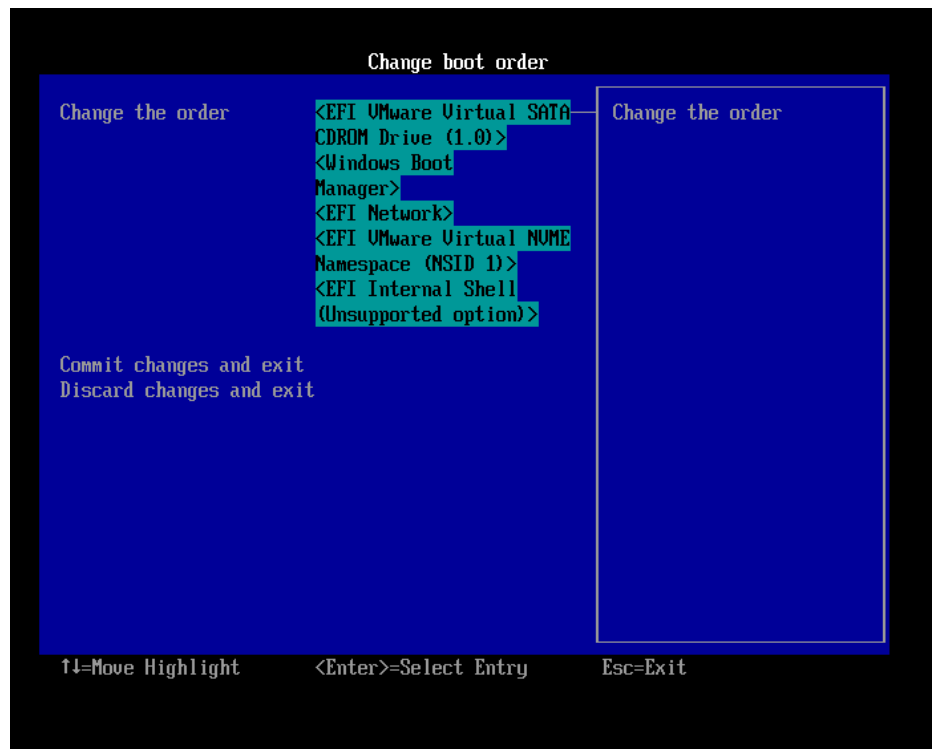
This is the order of devices that the system goes through in order to find a boot file to boot the OS.

If it doesn't find a file in the first option, it will move onto the second one in the list and so on, until it finds a file.

On your Windows10 VM, it is likely that "Windows Boot Manager" will be the first option on the list. This option will mean that the system will look to the hard drive initially for the boot file and load up the Windows operating system.

We don't want this to occur, so need to change it so that the system looks to the CDROM drive in the first instance to boot from out Kali Linux Live CD.

To do this, ensure that the boot order is highlighted, as below, and press **Enter**.

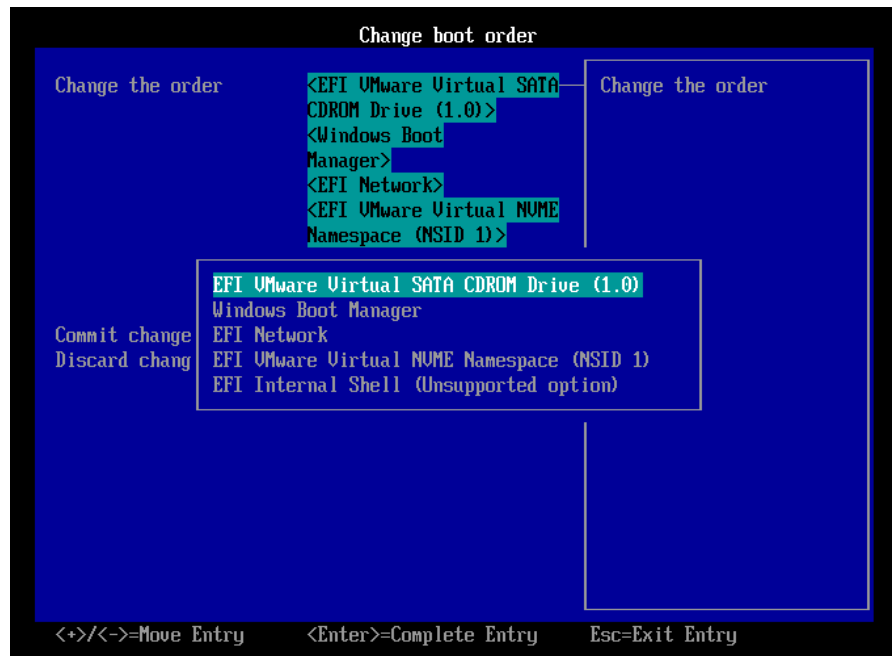


6. This will then open up a pop-up window that will allow you to change the boot order.

Use the arrow key to scroll down to highlight the “**VMware Virtual SATA CDROM Drive**” option.

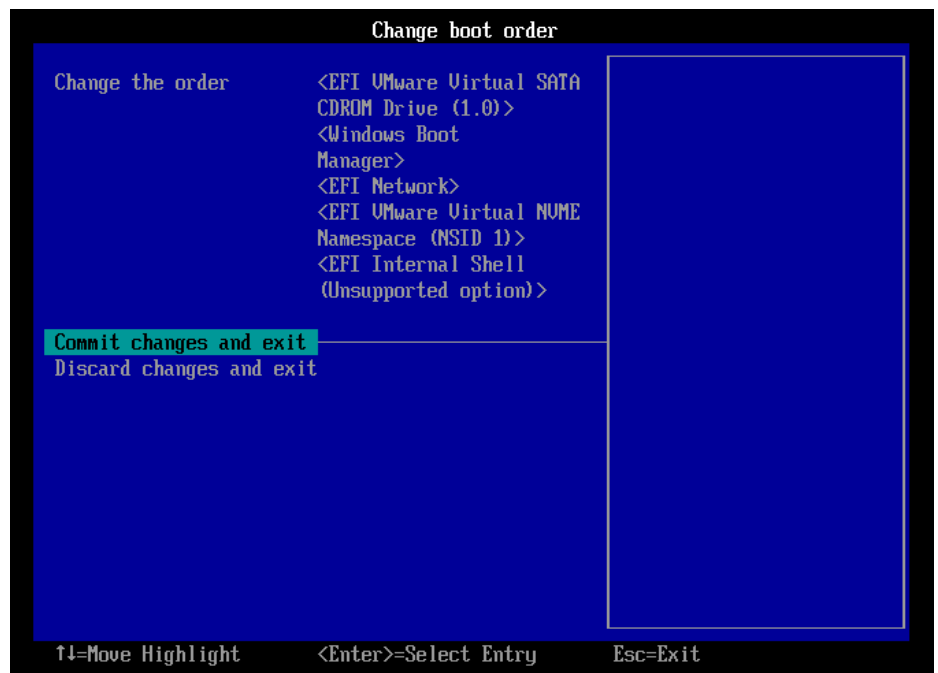
Once highlighted, use the “+” key to move the option to the top of the list like image below.

Press **Enter**

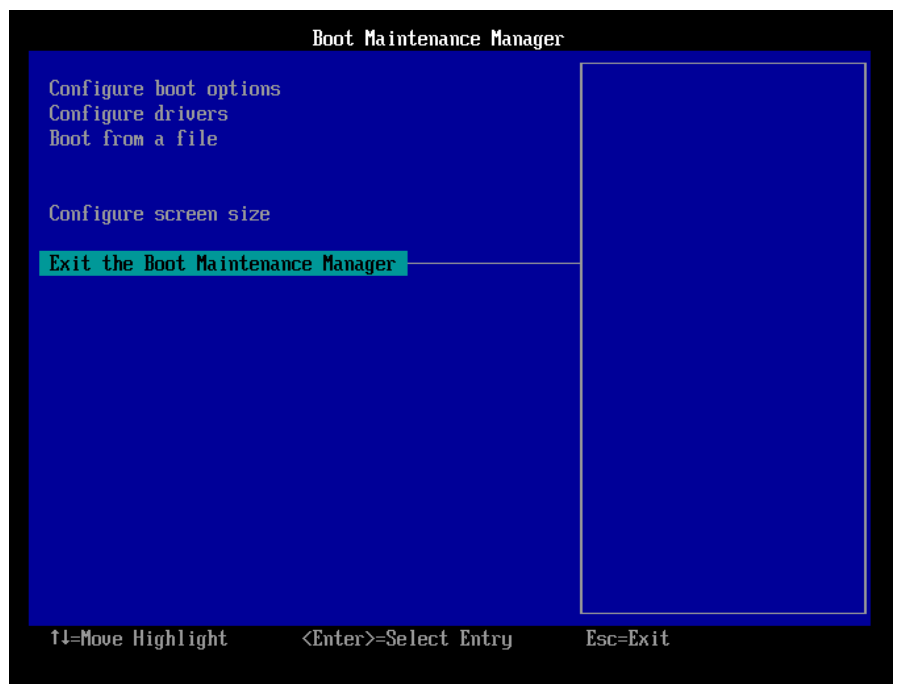


7. Ensure that the boot order has in fact changed to show the CDROM is the first option in the boot order.

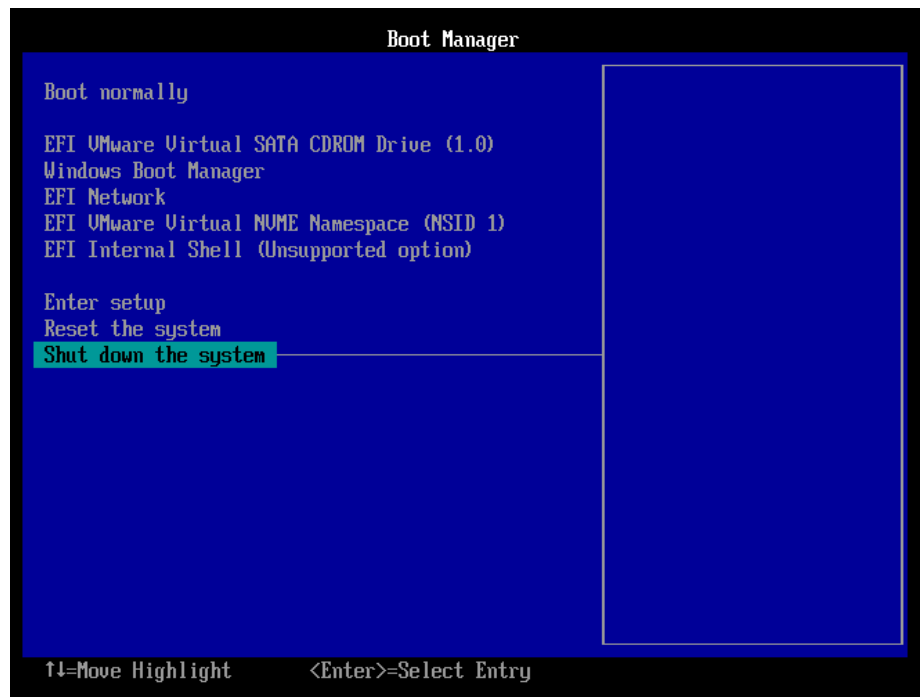
Press the down arrow to highlight “**Commit changes and exit**”.



8. From the Boot Maintenance Manager, highlight **“Exit the Boot Maintenance Manager”** and press **Enter**



9. From the main “**Boot Manager**” menu, highlight “**Shut down the system**” and press **Enter**.



10. Once the VM has shut down, re-start the VM.

Once it loads up, you should be presented with the options below.

Select the “**Live system (amd64)**” option.



11. Once the OS loads up, you will be presented with a Kali Desktop.

This operating system is running on top of your Windows System, with the Windows file system still available underneath.

